

Benny the Bunny and the Big Adventure on the Everyday Path

Little adventurers • 3-4 years old



Part 1

Benny the Bunny woke up in his cozy burrow. The morning sun made warm squares on the floor.

“Good morning, world,” Benny whispered.

Today was “Helper Day.” Benny loved Helper Day.

Mama Bunny tied a small blue scarf around his neck. “Can you bring these muffins to Granny Fern?” she asked. She put a little basket in his paws. It smelled sweet and safe.

“I can!” said Benny. He stood tall. Then he wiggled his nose. “And I will be brave.”

Outside, the path to Granny’s house was the same path as always. But Benny pretended it was a grand adventure trail. The grass looked like a soft green ocean. The daisies looked like tiny suns.

Benny hopped-hop-hopped. “One, two, three,” he counted, just because it felt good.

At the corner near the garden gate, he heard a small voice.

“Uh-oh,” said the voice.

Benny peeked behind a flower pot. A little snail was there. His shell was shiny like a button. He looked worried.

“My name is Shelly,” said the snail. “I want to cross the path, but the path feels so big.”

Benny smiled. "Hi, Shelly. I'm Benny. We can do it together."

Shelly blinked slowly. "Together?"

"Together," Benny said. "We can be a team."

So Benny walked next to Shelly. He went slow. Very slow. Slow like a sleepy cloud.

Benny's basket felt a bit heavy. He shifted it from one paw to the other. He did not mind. Helping felt good.

"Look," Benny said. "The big path is just ground. We can cross it step by step."

Shelly took a tiny slide forward. "Step by step," Shelly repeated.

They reached the other side. Shelly's eyes looked brighter.

"Thank you," said Shelly. "You are very kind."

Benny bowed a little. "You're welcome. Kind is my favorite."

Then Benny hopped on. Hop-hop-hopped. The basket swayed. The muffins stayed snug.

Soon he reached the little wooden bridge over the puddle stream. It was not a scary stream. It was a giggly stream. It made tiny plop sounds as drops fell.

Benny stepped onto the bridge.

Creeeak.

He froze. His ears went up.

Creeeak.

The bridge was safe, but the sound surprised him. Benny's tummy felt tight like a knot in a ribbon.

Benny put one paw on his chest. "It's okay," he told himself softly. "I can calm down."

He looked at the sky. He looked at the basket. He looked at his own paws.

"I will count to ten," Benny said.

"One," he whispered.

"Two."

"Three."

"Four."

"Five."

The stream bubbled kindly below.

"Six."

"Seven."

"Eight."

"Nine."

"Ten."

Benny took a slow breath. The knot loosened. His whiskers stopped trembling.

"I did it," Benny said. "Brave and calm."

He crossed the bridge with little careful steps. Creeeak. Creeeak. It sounded like the bridge was singing.

On the other side, Benny laughed. "Nice song, bridge!"

Part 2

Near Granny Fern's yard, Benny saw a small flock of sparrows. They bounced in the dust like tiny brown balls.

One sparrow flapped and chirped, "We lost our shiny button!"

Another sparrow said, "It rolled under the big bench."

Benny walked closer. "Can I help?"

The sparrows looked at his basket. "You are busy," they chirped.

"I can still help," Benny said. "Helping is part of my trip."

Benny kneeled by the bench. It was a little dark under there. Not scary dark, just shade-dark.

He used his clever bunny nose. Sniff-sniff. He saw something round.

But it was too far for his paw.

Benny looked around. He spotted a thin stick. "Ah-ha," he said, like a tiny explorer.

He slid the stick under the bench. He pushed gently. Roll, roll, roll.

Out came the shiny button!

The sparrows chirped loud and happy. “Hooray! Thank you, Bunny Benny!”

Benny held up the button. “Here you go,” he said. “A button should be with its friends.”

The sparrows tucked it safely into a little leaf pouch. They bobbed at Benny. “You are smart,” they said. “And generous.”

Benny’s cheeks felt warm. “I just like to share my time,” he said.

Then he remembered the muffins. “Oh! Granny Fern is waiting.”

He hurried, but not too fast. The muffins needed a gentle hop.

At Granny’s door, Benny knocked. Tap-tap.

Granny Fern opened the door with a smile as wide as a crescent moon. “Benny! Come in, sweet bun.”

Benny stepped inside. The house smelled like tea and honey.

“I brought muffins from Mama,” Benny said, holding out the basket with both paws. “And I had a big adventure.”

Granny Fern clapped softly. “Mmm! Thank you. You are very thoughtful.”

Benny told her about Shelly the snail. He told her about the singing bridge. He told her about the sparrows’ button.

Granny listened with bright eyes. “You used courage,” she said. “You used your brain. You kept going. That is resilience.”

Benny tried the long word. “Re-sil-ee-ence.”

Granny nodded. “It means you can bounce back, like a little ball.”

Benny giggled. “Boing!”

Granny poured two warm cups of tea. Benny had warm milk with a tiny drop of honey.

Granny cut one muffin in half. She put one half on Benny’s plate and one half on a small saucer.

“What is that for?” Benny asked.

Granny winked. “For any friend who might pass by.”

Just then, there was a soft scrape at the doorstep.

Shelly the snail was there.

Benny gasped with delight. “Shelly! You found us!”

Shelly smiled slowly. “I followed your kind hops. Also, I smelled muffins.”

Everyone laughed.

Benny slid the saucer closer. “This is for you,” he said. “We share here.”

Shelly took a tiny nibble. “Best adventure snack,” he said.

Outside, the sparrows perched on the window and chirped a thank-you song. The bridge, far away, kept singing its quiet creaks. The day felt bright and gentle.

When it was time to go home, Granny wrapped two extra muffins. “For you and Mama,” she said. “And one more... for sharing.”

Benny carried the basket carefully. “I will share,” he promised.

He hopped home with a calm heart.

Hop-hop-hopped.

Brave bunny. Clever bunny. Kind bunny.

At his burrow, Mama Bunny hugged him. Benny yawned a happy yawn.

“Big day?” Mama asked.

Benny nodded. “A very big adventure,” he said. “Right on the everyday path.”

Then Benny closed his eyes, warm and safe, and dreamed of bridges that sang and friends who never had to cross alone.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) Who is the main character of the story?

- Benny the Bunny
- Shelly the Snail
- Granny Fern
- A sparrow

2) Where did Benny take the muffins?

- To Granny Fern
- To the pond
- To the big bench
- To the bakery

3) Who did Benny help cross the path?

- Shelly the Snail
- A sparrow
- Granny Fern
- Mama Bunny

4) What did Granny give Benny to take home?

- Extra muffins
- A shiny button
- A stick
- A blue scarf

Correct answers:

1) Benny the Bunny 2) To Granny Fern 3) Shelly the Snail 4) Extra muffins

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Burrow.: A small home underground where a bunny sleeps and hides.

Helper Day.: A special day to do kind jobs and help others.

Scarf: A soft cloth you wear around your neck to keep warm.

Basket: A container you carry with your paws to hold things.

Sniff-sniff.: The sound of smelling something with your nose.

Creeeak.: A long, squeaky noise made by a old wooden thing.

Resilience.: The ability to bounce back and keep trying after trouble.

Saucer.: A small round plate that sits under a cup.